[METRIC]

A-A-897A
August 23,1993
SUPERSEDES
A-A-897
October 31,1980

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

PAPER PLACE MAT OR PAPER TRAY COVER (PAPER, DOILY)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description, for all Federal Agencies.

1. SCOPE. This commercial item description covers white, paper place mats to be used on food service trays in hospitals and other institutions.

2. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

2.1 Description. Place mats furnished under this description shall be made from bleached chemical wood pulp and shall have an embossed surface with either straight or scalloped edges.

2.2 Workmanship. The place mats shall be clean and free of holes, tears, wrinkles, ragged edges, dirt or foreign particles that adversely affect appearance or serviceability. There shall be no visible clumps of undispersed fibers or thin looking areas in the place mat. Packaged place mats shall be easy to separate from one another without sticking together or pulling fibers from the paper surfaces.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza New York, N.Y. 10278.

Distribution Statement A:
Approved for public release;
Distribution is unlimited.

FSC 8540

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2.3 **Physical Requirements.**

TABLE I

CHARACTERISTIC	REQUIREMENT	TEST METHOD
Basis Weight g/m2, min. lbs.(24 X 36-500) min.	40 (25#)	T 410
Dry Tensile Strength, minimum MD, grams/cm CD, grams/cm	 1400(50oz.) 700(25oz.)	T 404
Wet Tensile Strength, minimum MD, grams/cm	 140 (5oz.)	T 456
Brightness, percent, min.	72	T 452

2.4 **Style and Dimensions.** Place mats shall be either Style A or Style B. The corners shall be either straight or rounded.

Style A: Straight edges
Place mats shall be either 457 +/- 13mm x 305 +/- 13 mm (18 +/- 1/2 inch x 12 +/- 1/2 inch) or 508 +/- 13 mm x 381 +/- 13 mm (20 +/- 1/2 inch x 15 +/- 1/2 inch), as specified in the ordering data.

Style B: Scallop edges
Place mats shall be 483 +/- 13 mm x 356 +/- 13 mm (19 +/- 1/2 inch x 14 +/- 1/2 inch).
The scallop depth shall be not more than 8 mm (5/16 inch).

2.5 **General Requirements.**

2.5.1 **Odor.** Place mats shall have no disagreeable odor, either wet or dry.

2.5.2 **Color.** Place mats shall be white and of uniform color.

2.5.3 **Finish.** Place mats shall be embossed.

3. **Bleaching.** To obtain an acceptable brightness, or color, in accordance with this document, a chemical bleaching process may be used. When specified (see Paragraph 7) the bleaching process shall not include the use of chlorine, chlorine dioxide, hypochlorite, or other chlorine containing compounds. Certification of compliance shall be made available upon request by the Government.

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4. **Regulatory Requirements.** The paper used in the manufacture of place mats shall conform to the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, Title 21, Code of Federal Regulations and the regulations promulgated therein.

5. **Quality Assurance Provisions.** Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all the inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the contractor may utilize his own facilities or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this Commercial Item Description, where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Sampling for examination and tests shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, using the plans specified in Table II, unless otherwise stated. For the purposes of sampling, a lot shall consist of all place mats submitted for inspection at one time. Random samples shall be drawn from each lot for the end item inspection. Unless otherwise specified, every lot shall be tested.

For preparation for delivery examination, the sample unit shall be one fully prepared shipping container. For all other examinations, the sample unit shall be one place mat, unless specified otherwise.

TABLE II

Examine	Inspection Level	AQL (% defect)/ Acceptance
Workmanship/ General	S-3	4.0
Dimensional/Style	S-4	2.5
Preparation for delivery	S-2	2.5
Physical Properties	per Tappi	per Tappi

6. **APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS AND DOCUMENT SOURCES.** The following documents form a part of this Commercial Item Description to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

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6.1 TAPPI Standards.

T 400 Sampling and Accepting a Single Lot of Paper, Paperboard, Fiberboard or Related Product
T 402 Standard Conditioning and Testing Atmospheres for Paper, Board, Pulp Handsheets and Related Products
T 404 Tensile Breaking Strength and Elongation of Paper and Paperboard (Using Pendulum-Type Tester)
T 410 Grammage of Paper and Paperboard(Weight per Unit Area)
T 452 Brightness of Pulp, Paper and Paperboard (Directional Reflectance at 457 nm)
T 456 Wet Tensile Breaking Strength of Paper and Paperboard

Copies of Tappi Standards are available from the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, PO Box 105113, Atlanta, Ga 30348.

6.2 Federal Standards.

Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, Handbooks, and Commercial Item Descriptions (CIDs), as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions. The Index, which includes cumulative bimonthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

Single copies of Commercial Item Descriptions, federal standards or specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston; New York; Philadelphia; Washington, D. C.; Atlanta; Chicago; Kansas City, MO; For Worth; Houston; Denver; Los Angeles; San Francisco; and Auburn, WA. They may also be obtained from: GSA Specifications Unit (3FBP-W), 7th and D Streets S.W., Washington, DC 20407.

6.3 Military Standards.

MIL-STD-105, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes, is available from Standardization Documents Order Desk, Bldg. 4D, 700 Robbins Ave., Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.

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6.4 Code of Federal Regulations, Title 21

Copies of the U.S. Code of Federal Regulations may be purchased with a VISA, Master Card, or prepaid check through:
Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402
Phone (202) 783-3238

When ordering, ask for:
Title 21, Parts 170-199
Stock Number: 869-017-00-068-0

7. Notes.

A. Ordering Data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(1) Title, number, and date of this Commercial Item Description.
(2) Packaging, packing and marking
(3) Dimensions
(4) Bleaching (see Paragraph 3)
(5) Style

B. Item Identifiers/Reference Part Number System (For Cataloging Use Only).

AA897-1 :This example describes a place mat with straight edges.

Style 1- Style A - Straight edges
2- Style B - Scalloped edges

MILITARY INTEREST:

NONE: DoD has no registered interest in revisions and amendments to this Commercial Item Description until further notice.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA-FSS

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